Introduction to the Practice of Politics.

Edmund Kelly.

Trinity Term 2025.

Welcome to Introduction to the Practice of Politics. This course covers four main themes.

1. Constitutional variations under democracy.
2. Political institutions and practice outside of the advanced industrial democracies.
3. The institutions of the democratic state.
4. Parties, party systems, values, identity politics.

I will assign each of you one (different) essay question each week. You can find the reading material for each week using SOLO, in physical and/or online format.

Please email your essays to me, and to your tutorial partners, by 5pm on Wednesdays. I won't be able to make late essays.

Tutorials will be held on Fridays, in Room 132 of the Manor Road Building. Please read everyone's essays before the tutorial and come ready to discuss them.

Any questions or concerns, please reach out to me at edmund.kelly@politics.ox.ac.uk.

Essay criteria.

1. Maximum 1600 words, excluding bibliography. Over-length essays may not be marked.
2. Sensible font and font size.
3. Double spaced.
4. Proper referencing in the text (in any sensible, consistent format).
5. Full bibliography at the end (in any sensible, consistent format).

Reading list key.

*** indicates highly recommended.

Week 1. Presidentialism and parliamentarism

Reading

Clark, W.R., Matt Golder, and Sonia Golder, 2009. Principles of Comparative Government, Washington, (Chapter 11: "Parliamentary, Presidential, and Mixed Democracies", pp. 395-461) (Introductory: start here)

Sedelius, T. and Åberg, J., 2017. Eastern Europe's Semi-Presidential Regimes. In Fagan, A., & Kopecký, P. (eds.) The Routledge Handbook of East European Politics (pp. 67-81). Routledge.

Chaisty, P., Cheeseman, N. and Power, T., 2014. Rethinking the 'presidentialism debate': conceptualizing coalitional politics in cross-regional perspective. Democratization, 21(1), pp.72-94.

Samuels, D., 2007: "Separation of Powers". In The Oxford Handbook of Comparative Politics, ed. Carles Boix and Susan C. Stokes, New York.

Lijphart, A., 2012. Patterns of Democracy. Government Forms and Performance in Thirty-Six Countries, New Haven.

Juan Linz 'The Perils of Presidentialism' in Journal of Democracy 1 (1) 1990

Elgie, R., 1998. "The Classification of Democratic Regime Types: Conceptual Ambiguity and Contestable Assumptions", European Journal of Political Research, 33: 219-38

Cheibub, J.A., 2007. Presidentialism, Parliamentarianism, and Democracy, New York

Siaroff, A., 2003. 'Comparative Presidencies: The Inadequacy of the Presidential, Semi Presidential and Parliamentary Distinction', European Journal of Political Research, 42(3), pp. 287-312.

Van Cranenburgh, Oda "'Big Men Rule': presidential power, regime type and democracy in 30 African countries" Democratization 15-5 (2008)

Duverger, M. (1980). 'A New Political System Model: Semi-Presidential Government'. *European Journal of Political Research*, 45: 627-49

Tsebelis, G. (2002), *Veto Players: How political institutions work* (especially chapters 1-4)

Tsebelis, G. (1995). 'Decision-making in Political Systems: Veto-players in Presidentialism, Multi-cameralism and Multi-partysim', *British Journal of Political Science* 25: 289-326

Grotz, F., Müller-Rommel, F., Berz, J., Kroeber, C. and Kukec, M., (2021). 'How Political Careers affect Prime-Ministerial Performance: Evidence from Central and Eastern Europe'. *Comparative Political Studies*

Week 2. Consensus and majoritarian democracy

Developing the consensus model.

Lijphart, A., (2012) Patterns of Democracy: Government Forms and Performance in Thirty-Six Countries (New Haven: Yale UP), Chs. 1-3, and on key claims see Chs. 15-16.

Lijphart, Arend. "Consociational democracy." World politics 21.2 (1969): 207 225.

Lijphart, Arend. "Typologies of democratic systems." Comparative political studies 1.1 (1968): 3-44.

Examining effects.

Bogaards, Matthijs. "Comparative Political Regimes: Consensus and Majoritarian Democracy." Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Politics. 2017.

Manatschal, Anita, and Julian Bernauer. "Consenting to exclude? Empirical patterns of democracy and immigrant integration policy." West European Politics 39.2 (2016): 183-204.

Poloni-Staudinger, Lori M. "Are consensus democracies more environmentally effective?" Environmental politics 17.3 (2008): 410-430.

Geissel, Brigitte, and Ank Michels. "Participatory developments in majoritarian and consensus democracies." Representation 54.2 (2018): 129-146.

Bogaards, Matthijs. "Kinder, gentler, safer? A re-examination of the relationship between consensus democracy and domestic terrorism." Studies in Conflict & Terrorism 43.10 (2020): 886-903.

Qvortrup, Matt. "The logic of domestic terrorism revisited: a response to a critic." Studies in Conflict & Terrorism 43.10 (2020): 904-909.

Critiquing cases.

Russell, Meg, and Ruxandra Serban. "The Muddle of the 'Westminster Model': A concept stretched beyond repair." Government and Opposition (2020): 1-21.

Strohmeier, Gerd. "Does Westminster (still) represent the Westminster model? An analysis of the changing nature of the UK's political system." European View 14.2 (2015): 303-315. "Consensus Democracy in the Netherlands" in Van Praag, Philip. Political science and changing politics. Amsterdam University Press, 2017.

Jónsson, Guðmundur. "Iceland and the Nordic model of consensus democracy." Scandinavian Journal of History 39.4 (2014): 510-528.

Week 3. Democracy and authoritarianism.

Conceptualizing democracy: Thick vs. thin conceptions.

William R Clark, Matt Golder and Sonia Golder, Principles of Comparative Politics, CQ Press, Washington, 2013/2017, (Chaps 5 and 10). i.e. the chapters on "Democracy and Dictatorship: Conceptualizing and Measurement" and "Varieties of Dictatorships"

Robert Dahl (1971) Polyarchy: Participation and Opposition (New Haven: Yale UP), p. 1-16

Dahl, R. 'What political institutions does large-scale democracy require?' Political Science Quarterly, 120, 2, 2005 http://www.jstor.org/stable/20202514,

Philippe Schmitter and Terry Lynn Karl (1991), "What Democracy Is... and Is Not" Journal of Democracy 2:3 (Summer): 75-88

Ahmed, Amel. Democracy and the politics of electoral system choice: engineering electoral dominance. Cambridge University Press, 2013.

Jeffrey Winters and Benjamin Page (2009), "Oligarchy in the United States?" Perspectives on Politics 7:4 (December): 731-751

Munck, G. and Verkuilen, J. (2002) 'Conceptualizing and measuring democracy', *Comparative Political Studies* 35: 5-34.

Chu, J.A., Williamson, S. and Yeung, E.S., 2024. People consistently view elections and civil liberties as key components of democracy. *Science*, *386*(6719), pp.291-296.

Hybrid and authoritarian regimes.

Levitsky, S. and L. Way (2002), 'The rise of competitive authoritarianism', *Journal of Democracy* 13: 51-65.

Collier, David, and Steven Levitsky. 1997. "Democracy with adjectives: Conceptual innovation in comparative research." World Politics 49.03: 430-451.

Art, David. 2012. "What do we know about authoritarianism after ten years?" Comparative Politics 44.3: 351-373.

Ahram, Ariel I., and J. Paul Goode. 2016. "Researching Authoritarianism in the Discipline of Democracy." Social Science Quarterly 97.4: 834-849.

Gilbert, Leah "Beyond Authoritarianism: The Conceptualization of Hybrid Regimes." Studies in Comparative International Development, 46(3). 270-297

Contemporary challenges to democracy

Robert Lieberman et al "The Trump Presidency and American Democracy: A Historical and Comparative Analysis," Perspectives on Politics 17, no. 2 June 2019

Rogers M Smith & Desmond King, “White Protectionism in America: Perspectives on Politics19 (2021), no 2.

Julius Maximilian Rogenhofer & Ayala Panievsky (2020) “Antidemocratic populism in power: comparing Erdoğan’s Turkey with Modi’s India and Netanyahu’s Israel”, Democratization, 27:8, 1394-1412

Vaishnav, M. (2021). Interview: Dr. Milan Vaishnav on the Threats to India’s Democracy. Georgetown Journal of International Affairs22(1), 7679.

Larry Diamond, ‘Democratic regression in comparative perspective” Democratization 28-1 (2021)

Little, A.T. and Meng, A., 2024. Measuring democratic backsliding. *PS: Political Science & Politics*, *57*(2), pp.149-161.

Scheve, K. and Stasavage, D., 2017. Wealth inequality and democracy. *Annual Review of Political Science*, *20*(1), pp.451-468.

Robinson, J.A., 2006. Economic development and democracy. Annu. Rev. Polit. Sci., 9(1), pp.503-527.

Kennedy, R., 2010. The contradiction of modernization: A conditional model of endogenous democratization. *The Journal of Politics*, *72*(3), pp.785-798.

Xuereb, S., Wohl, M.J., Stefaniak, A. and Elgar, F.J., 2021. Social and Economic Determinants of Support for a Strong Non-Democratic Leader in Democracies Differ From Non-Democracies. *Journal of Social and Political Psychology*, *9*(2), pp.334-352.

Week 4. Legislatures.

Structure and function.

Cox, Gary, “The organization of democratic legislatures” in B.R Weingast and D.A. Wittman (eds) The Oxford Handbook of Political Economy, OUP, 2006

Laver, M., “Legislatures and Parliaments in Comparative Context”, The Oxford Handbook of Political Economy OUP, 2006

Strom, K., “Parliamentary Democracy and Delegation” in Strøm, K., et al. Delegation and Accountability in Parliamentary Democracies, Oxford University Press 2003

Feminist and minority representation.

Lovenduski, Joni. 2019. “Feminist Reflections on Representative Democracy.” In Rethinking Democracy, edited by Andrew Gamble and Tony Wright, 18–35. Chichester, UK: John Wiley & Sons.

Celis, Karen, and Sarah Childs. Feminist democratic representation. Oxford University Press, 2020. chs. 1&2

Hänni, Miriam. "Presence, representation, and impact: how minority MPs affect policy outcomes." Legislative Studies Quarterly 42.1 (2017): 97-130.

Reher, Stefanie. "Do disabled candidates represent disabled citizens?" British Journal of Political Science (2021): 1-15.

Lea Ewe Bönisch, “What Factors Shape the Substantive Representation of Lesbians, Gays and Bisexuals in Parliament? Testing the Impact of Minority Membership, Political Values and Awareness”, Parliamentary Affairs, 2021

Class, professional politics and socialisation.

Bovens, Mark, and Anchrit Wille. Diploma democracy: The rise of political meritocracy. Oxford University Press, 2017. ch.7

O’Grady, Tom. "Careerists versus coal-miners: Welfare reforms and the substantive representation of social groups in the British Labour party." Comparative Political Studies 52.4 (2019): 544-578.

Erikson, Josefina, and Cecilia Josefsson. "Does higher education matter for MPs in their parliamentary work? Evidence from the Swedish parliament." Representation 55.1 (2019): 65-80.

Crewe, Emma (2015) The House of Commons: an anthropology of MPs at work. Manchester. Manchester University Press. chs. 1, 4 and 7

Dickinson, Nicholas. "Advice giving and party loyalty: An informational model for the socialisation process of new British MPs." Parliamentary Affairs 71.2 (2018): 343 364.

Carnes, N. and Lupu, N., 2016. What good is a college degree? Education and leader quality reconsidered. *The Journal of Politics*, *78*(1), pp.35-49.

Hanretty, C., Mellon, J. and English, P., 2021. Members of parliament are minimally accountable for their issue stances (and they know it). *American Political Science Review*, *115*(4), pp.1275-1291.

Cowley, P. and Umit, R., 2023. Legislator dissent does not affect electoral outcomes. *British Journal of Political Science*, *53*(2), pp.789-795.

Russell, M. and Cowley, P., 2016. The policy power of the Westminster parliament: The "parliamentary state" and the empirical evidence. *Governance*, *29*(1), pp.121-137.

Country case studies.

Simone Burkhart & Matthias Lehnert (2008) "Between Consensus and Conflict: Law-Making Processes in Germany", German Politics, 17:3, 223-231

Hennis, Wilhelm. "Reform of the Bundestag: The Case for General Debate" in British & French Parliaments in Comparative Perspective. Routledge, 2017. 97 110.

Dodd, Lawrence C., and Bruce Ian Oppenheimer. Congress Reconsidered. 11thed. Thousand Oaks, California, 2017. Print. chs.1-2

Vernon Hewitt & Shirin M. Rai (2010) ch. 3 'The Indian Parliament' in Niraja Gopal Jayal & Pratap Bhanu Mehta (eds.) The Oxford Companion to Politics in India. 2010.

Morgenstern & Nacif (2010) Legislative Politics in Latin America, especially chs. 6, 8 & 11

Joel Barkan (ed.) (2009) Legislative Power in Emerging African Democracies ch. 1

Helen Drake et al. (2020) Developments in French Politics 6, chapter on France by Rainbow Murray

Demarest L. (2021), Men of the people? Democracy and prebendalism in Nigeria's Fourth Republic National Assembly, Democratization 28(4): 684-702.

Collord, Michaela. "Pressuring MPs to act: parliament, organized interests and policymaking in Uganda and Tanzania." Democratization 28.4 (2021): 723-741.

Week 5. Parties and voters

Introducing foundations of people's vote choice.

Clarke, Harold, David Sanders, Marianne C. Stewart and Paul Whiteley. 2004. Political Choice in Britain, Oxford University Press, Ch. 2.

Stokes, Susan C. 2006. "Do Informal Rules Make Democracy Work? Accounting for Accountability in Argentina." In Informal Institutions and Democracy. Lessons from Latin America, eds. Gretchen Helmke and Steven Levitsky. Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press, pp. 125-139.

Stability and variation in programmatic party-voter linkages.

Achen, C. and L. Bartels (2016), *Democracy for Realists*. Princeton University Press.

Van der Eijk, Cees and Mark Franklin. 2012. Elections and Voters, Palgrave MacMillan: Political Analysis Series, Ch. 7.

Dalton, Russell J. 2019. Citizen Politics: Public Opinion and Political Parties in Advanced Industrial Democracies. Washington: CQ Press, Ch. 8, 9, and 10.

Inglehart, Ronald. 1981. Post-Materialism in an Environment of Insecurity, American Political Science Review, 75(4): 880-900.

Evans, Geoffrey. 2000. The Continued Significance of Class Voting. Annual Review of Political Science, 3: 401-17.

Evans, G. and J. Tilley (2017), *The New Politics of Class: The political exclusion of the British working class* (Oxford: Oxford University Press).

Letki, Natalia. 2013. "Do Social Divisions Explain Political Choices? The Case of Poland." In Political Choice Matters. Explaining the Strength of Class and Religious Cleavages in Cross-National Perspective, eds. Geoffrey Evans and Nan Dirk de Graaf. Oxford: Oxford University Press, pp. 337-358.

Junn, Jane, and Natalie Masuoka. 2019. "The Gender Gap is a Race Gap. Women Voters in US Presidential Elections." Perspectives on Politics 18(4): 1135-1145

Stoker, Laura and Kent Jennings. 2009. Of Time and the Development of Partisan Polarization, American Journal of Political Science 52(3): 619-35.

Levendusky, Matthew. 2012. The Partisan Sort: How Liberals became more Democrats and Conservatives Became Republicans. London: The University of Chicago Press, Ch. 1, 3, 5 & 6.

Hobolt, Sara B., Thomas J. Leeper, and James Tilley. 2020. "Divided by the Vote. Affective Polarization in the Wake of the Brexit Referendum." British Journal of Political Science, pp. 1-18, doi:10.1017/S0007123420000125.

Hatemi and Ojeda (2020), 'The role of child perception and motivation in political socialization', *British Journal of Political Science*.

Mondak, J.J., and K.D. Halperin (2008), 'A framework for the study of personality and political behaviour.' *British Journal of Political Science*: 335-362.

Willoughby, E.A. et al (2021), 'Parent contributions to the development of political attitudes', *Psychological Science* 31(1): 2023-2034.

Converse, P. (1969), 'Of time and partisan stability'. *Comparative Political Studies* 2: 139-171.

Stability and variation in non-programmatic linkages

Yıldırım, Kerem and Herbert Kitschelt. 2020. "Analytical Perspectives on Varieties of Clientelism." Democratization 27(1): 20-43.

Auyero, Javier. 2001. Poor People's Politics. Durham: Duke University Press, pp. 1 17, 152182.

Chandra, Kanchan. 2007. "Counting Heads. A Theory of Voter and Elite Behavior in Patronage Democracies." In Patrons, Clients and Policies. Patterns of Democratic Accountability and Political Competition, eds. Herbert Kitschelt and Steven Wilkinson. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, pp. 84-109.

Wantchekon, Leonard. 2003. "Clientelism and Voting Behavior. Evidence from a Field Experiment in Benin." World Politics 55(3): 399-422.

Munoz, Paula. 2018. Buying Audience. Clientelism and Electoral Campaigns When Parties Are Weak. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, Ch. 1, 4, and 6.

Week 6. Populism and the far right.

Populism as a concept

Mudde, Cas, and Pablo Rovira Kaltwasser, eds. 2013. Populism in Europe and the Americas: Threat or corrective for democracy? Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. Chapter 1 and 10.

Engler, Sarah. 2024. Centrist Anti-Establishment Parties and Their Struggle for Survival. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Chapter 1 – 3

Halikiopoulou, Daphne et al., 'The Paradox of Nationalism: The Common Denominator of Radical Right and Radical Left Euroscepticism', European Journal of Political Research, 51 (4), 2012, 504-539

Jan-Werner Müller. What is populism? University of Pennsylvania Press, 2016

Peters, B. G., and Jon Pierre. 2020. "A typology of populism: understanding the different forms of populism and their implications." Democratization 27 (6): 928–46.

Weyland, Kurt. 2001. "Clarifying a Contested Concept: Populism in the Study of Latin American Politics." Comparative Politics 34 (1): 1–22

Wuttke, Alexander, Christian Schimpf, and Harald Schoen. 2020. 'When the whole is greater than the sum of its parts: On the conceptualization and measurement of populist attitudes and other multidimensional constructs.' *American Political Science Review* 114 (2): 356-374.

Canovan, Margaret. 1999. "Trust the people." Political Studies 47 (1): 2–16

The far right

Mudde, Cas. 2007. Populist radical right parties in Europe. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. Chapter 1 and 3

Rydgren, Jens. 2018. "The Radical Right: An Introduction." In The Oxford handbook of the radical right, ed. Jens Rydgren. New York: Oxford University Press, 1–14

Coffé, Hilde. 2018. "Gender and the Radical Right." In The Oxford handbook of the radical right, ed. Jens Rydgren. New York: Oxford University Press, 200–211

Golder, Matt. 2016. "Far Right Parties in Europe." Annual Review of Political Science 19 (1): 477–97

Froio, Caterina. 2018. "Race, Religion, or Culture? Framing Islam between Racism and Neo-Racism in the Online Network of the French Far Right." Perspectives on Politics 16 (3): 696–709

Krause, Werner, Denis Cohen, and Tarik Abou-Chadi. 2023. “Does accommodation work? Mainstream party strategies and the success of radical right parties.” Political Science Research and Methods 11 (1): 172-179

Why do people vote for anti-establishment parties?

Bakker, B.N., Rooduijn, M. and Schumacher, G., 2016. The psychological roots of populist voting: Evidence from the United States, the Netherlands and Germany. *European Journal of Political Research*, *55*(2), pp.302-320.

Biggs, M. and Knauss, S., 2012. Explaining membership in the British National Party: A multilevel analysis of contact and threat. *European Sociological Review*, *28*(5), pp.633-646.

Dahlstrom and Sundell (2012), ‘A losing gamble: How mainstream parties facilitate anti-immigrant party success’, *Electoral Studies* 31: 353-363.

Golder, Matt (2003) Explaining variation in the success of extreme right parties in Western Europe. *Comparative Political Studies.*

Grant, Z.P. (2021). ‘Crisis and Convergence: How the Combination of a Weak Economy and Mainstream Party Ideological De-Polarization Fuels Anti-System Support.’ *Comparative Political Studies* 54(7): 1256-1291.

Grant, Z.P. and Tilley, J., (2019), “Fertile soil: explaining variation in the success of Green parties.” *West European Politics* 42(3): 495-516.

Hiers, W., Soehl, T. and Wimmer, A., 2017. National trauma and the fear of foreigners: How past geopolitical threat heightens anti-immigration sentiment today. *Social Forces*, *96*(1), pp.361-388.

Meguid, Bonnie M. 2005. ‘Competition between unequals: The role of mainstream party strategy in niche party success.’ *American Political Science Review* 99(3): 347-359.

Oesch, Daniel, and Line Rennwald (2018), ‘Electoral Competition in Europe's New Tripolar Political Space: Class Voting for the Left, Centre-Right and Radical Right’, *European Journal of Political Research* 7(2): 271.

Rooduijn, M., Van Der Brug, W. and De Lange, S.L., 2016. Expressing or fuelling discontent? The relationship between populist voting and political discontent. *Electoral studies*, *43*, pp.32-40.

Van Kessel, Stijn (2011), ‘Explaining the electoral performance of populist parties: the Netherlands as a case study." *Perspectives on European Politics and Society* 12: 68-88.